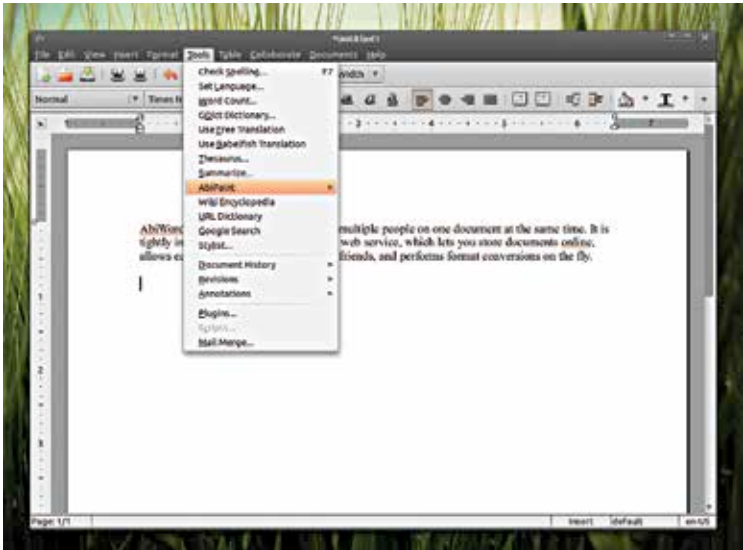




Abiword is a free, standalone word processor for Linux, Windows and Mac systems

papers, reports and letters using the layout editing options, and polish it up with standard formatting and grammar/spelling features. GNUMERIC, a spreadsheet program by the GNOME Project, is another worthy mention. You should know though that it lacks advanced features such as pivot tables and macros found in Microsoft Excel, and doesn't support the newer .xlsx format for spreadsheets.

3. GNU Octave/MATLAB

MATLAB is a popular tool for mathematical and statistical analysis, plotting curves and simulation of real-world systems. It's widely used in academia in fields as diverse as Mathematics, Fluid Mechanics, Digital Audio Processing and Aerodynamics. While an official Linux port of MATLAB exists, its performance leaves a lot to be desired. Additionally, MATLAB is proprietary software and requires an expensive license to use it. A free, open source alternative is GNU Octave, a command line tool that includes some of the same methods and functions for performing mathematical analysis and simulations. As of version 3.8 of Octave (released earlier in 2014), a graphical front-end has been added, bringing it closer in appearance to MATLAB.